INTERIM FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

RACK, DISTRIBUTOR, DESK

This Interim Federal Specification was prepared by the Standardization Division, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D. C. 20407, based upon currently available technical information. It is recommended that Federal agencies use it in procurement and forward recommendations for changes to the preparing activity at the address shown above.

1. SCOPE AND CLASSIFICATION

1.1 Scope. This specification covers distributor racks which provide a series of open fan-type or vertical filing compartments (see 6.1).

1.2 Classification.

1.2.1 Types. The distributor racks covered by this specification shall be of the following types as specified (see 6.2):

Type I - Fan type

4 compartments
6 compartments
8 compartments
15 compartments

Type II - Vertical type

5 compartments
8 compartments
12 compartments
15 compartments

1.2.2 Classes. The racks shall be of the following classes, as specified, (see 6.2):

Class A. - Metal
Class B. - Wood

1.2.3 Color (see 3.5).

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS

2.1 The following specifications and standards, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

TT-I-58 - Lacquer, Spraying, Clear and Pigmented (General Use)
TT-S-300 - Shellac, Cut
LLI-H-35 - Hardwood, Fibrous-felted (Fiberboard)
PPP-B-566 - Boxes, Folding, Paperboard
PPP-B-601 - Boxes, Wood, Cleated-Plywood
PPP-B-636 - Box, Fiberboard
PPP-B-665 - Boxes, Paperboard, Metal Stayed (Including Stay Material)
PPP-B-676 - Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard
PPP-T-60 - Tape; Pressure Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof - for Packaging and Sealing

Federal Standard:

Fed. Std. No. 102 - Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels
Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies)

NOTE: FOR INSTRUCTIONS ON OBTAINING COPIES OF FEDERAL SPECIFICATIONS AND STANDARDS, SEE LAST PAGE.

FSC 7520

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Military Specification:

MIL-L-10547 - Liners, Case, Waterproof

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by contractors in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring agency or as directed by the contracting officer.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Each bidder shall furnish with his bid descriptive data which shall include cuts, illustrations or photographs of the type of rack and such other data as may be necessary to show exactly what he proposes to furnish under this specification.

3.2 Material.

3.2.1 Metal. The metal shall be of commercial quality cold rolled steel, except as specified in 3.4.3.2. The metal shall be bright, smooth, free from rust, scale, pits, scratches, crimps, and buckles.

3.2.2 Wood. Wood parts shall be of oak, maple, birch, yellow poplar, gum or similar hardwood of equivalent strength and mechanical properties. The wood shall be properly kiln dried to a moisture content of not less than 5 percent nor more than 8 percent, and shall be free from knots, shakes, sap discolorations, brashness, or other defects which may affect the appearance or serviceability of the rack.

3.2.3 Hardboard. Hardboard, when used, shall conform to Type I, Class 1, smooth-two-sides, of Federal Specification LLL-H-35.

3.2.4 Finishing materials.

3.2.4.1 Enamel. The quality of enamel, when applied for the final coat, shall be in accordance with distributor rack manufacturers' regular commercial products, except that the colors shall be as specified in 3.7, and the enamel shall be baked for not less than 45 minutes or in accordance with the enamel manufacturers' directions.

3.2.4.2 Lacquer. Lacquer, when applied, shall conform to Type I of Federal Specification TT-L-58.

3.2.4.3 Shellac. Shellac, when applied, shall conform to Type I, Grade B, Body 2 of Federal Specification TT-S-300.

3.3 Design and construction. The racks shall be the manufacturer's standard commercial design with typical features of construction which have been produced and sold commercially. The racks shall consist essentially of a base and dividing partitions which form a series of open fan type or vertical compartments. The number of compartments (1.2.1) shall be as specified in the invitation for bids (see 6.2). The dividing partitions may be stationary or designed to allow expansion, removal or adjustment to vary the number or size of the compartments, as specified (see 6.2). The base may be one piece or in sections and shall be provided with attached rubber, cork, felt, or other suitable type bumpers, or manufactured in such a manner as to preclude the possibility of scratching or marring the desk. The racks shall rest firmly on a flat surface and shall be sturdily constructed and sufficiently rigid to sustain properly the maximum load and wear imposed upon them. Unless otherwise specified, each compartment of the rack shall be provided with a suitable label holder which shall be readily visible and easy to operate.

3.3.1 Type I racks. Type I racks shall consist of a semicylindrical base having a flat bottom, and shall be provided with partitions extending in a fan-type arrangement to form compartments.

3.3.2 Type II racks. Type II racks shall be in the form of a rectangle with a flat base, and shall be provided with partitions extending in a vertical arrangement to form compartments.

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3.4 Dimensions.

3.4.1 Type I racks. The dimensions at the base of racks shall be not less than 2 inches high, 6-1/2 inches wide and 11 inches deep and not more than 4-1/2 inches high, 8-1/2 inches wide and 12 inches deep. Each compartment shall be not less than 7 inches high. When the racks are divided into compartments of approximately equal width, each compartment shall be not less than 3/4 inch wide at base.

3.4.2 Type II racks. The overall dimensions shall be not less than 7-1/2 inches high and 8 inches deep and not more than 12 inches high and 14 inches deep. The width dimension is determined by the number of compartments specified (see 6.2). When the racks are divided into compartments of equal width, each compartment shall be not less than 1 inch wide.

3.4.3 Class A - Metal.

3.4.3.1 Base. The base of the racks shall be at least 26 gage (0.0172 to 0.0194 inch) steel, Manufacturers' Standard Gage for Steel Sheets.

3.4.3.2 Dividers. The dividers shall be at least 24 gage (0.0225 to 0.0254 inch) steel, Manufacturers' Standard Gage for Steel Sheets. If steel wire is used, it shall be not less than No. 9 (0.148 inch) diameter, (Birmingham Wire Gage) of suitable strength.

3.4.4 Class B - Wood or wood and hardboard.

3.4.4.1 Base. The base shall be at least 0.75 inch thick.

3.4.4.2 Dividers. The dividers shall be at least 0.1 inch thick.

3.4.5 Tolerance. A plus or minus tolerance of 1/16 inch shall be permitted, unless otherwise stated.

3.5 Color. Racks shall be furnished, as specified in the invitation for bids, in one of the following colors (see 6.2): gray, green, mahogany or walnut.

3.6 Finish. Racks shall be finished inside and outside in the color specified (see 3.5). The finish of metal racks shall be baked enamel. The finish of wood or wood and hardboard racks shall be lacquer or shellac (see 3.2.4.2 or 3.2.4.3). All finishes shall level out to produce a smooth uniform surface and color, without runs, wrinkles, grit or areas of thin film. All metal parts shall be thoroughly coated with baked enamel or rendered corrosion resistant by metallic coating.

3.7 Identification marking. Each rack shall be marked in a plain manner with the manufacturer's name or with a trademark of such known character that the source of manufacture may be readily determined.

3.8 Workmanship. The method of fabricating, assembling and finishing the rack shall be in accordance with the best commercial practices characteristic of the quality of the product required by this specification. All parts shall be free of burrs and sharp edges, and all corners rounded.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Inspection responsibility. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own or any other inspection facilities and services acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order (see 6.2). The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.2 Sampling and inspection for acceptance. Sampling and inspection for acceptance shall be performed in accordance with MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated. For the purposes of sampling, an inspection lot shall consist of all distributor racks of one type and class submitted for inspection at one time.

4.2.1 Examination of the end item. The examination shall be based on an acceptable quality level (AQL) of 4.0 defects per hundred units and shall be in accordance with the classification of defects listed in Table I. The sample unit shall consist of one distributor rack. Inspection Level II shall be used.

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TABLE I

Examine	Defects
Material:	
Metal	Not bright, smooth, free from rust scale, pits, scratches, crimps and buckles.
Wood	Not hardwood of required strength and mechanical properties.
	Not free from knots, shakes, sap discolorations, brashness or other defects affecting appearance.
Hardboard	Not smooth two sides.
Design and construction:	Not manufacturer's standard commercial design.
	Number of compartments not as specified.
	Dividing partitions not stationary or adjustable, as specified.
	Base does not preclude possibility of scratching or marring desk.
	Does not rest firmly on flat surface, is not sturdily constructed or sufficiently rigid.
	Not provided with suitable label holder.
	Not type specified.
Dimensions:	Dimensions not as specified.
Finish:	Color not as specified. Not smooth and uniform.
	Runs, wrinkles, grit or areas of thin film or no film.
	Metal parts not thoroughly coated with baked enamel or rendered corrosion resistant by metallic coating, when required.
Identification marking:	Marking missing, incomplete or not as required.
Workmanship:	Burrs, sharp edges, corners not rounded, or evidence of fractures.

4.2.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. The examination shall be based on an acceptable quality level of 6.5 defects per hundred units and shall be in accordance with the classification of defects listed in table II. The sample unit shall be one shipping container, fully packed, selected just prior to the closing operation, and sampled at Inspection Level L-8. Shipping containers, fully prepared, shall be examined for closure defects.

TABLE II

Material:	Components missing, damaged or otherwise defective.
Closure and workmanship:	Closure of package or shipping container not as specified.
	Loose or missing strapping or tape, as applicable.
	Incomplete waterproofing of package or shipping container, as applicable.
	Damaged package or shipping container.
	Bulging or distortion of package or shipping container.
Content (quantity):	Number of distributor racks per package or shipping container not as specified.
Marking:	Omitted, incomplete, incorrect, illegible; of improper size, location or sequence.

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5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

(For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 102).

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 Level A. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2) each rack shall be individually packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-665, style optional; or to PPP-B-676, type optional; or to PPP-B-566, style and type optional. Each box shall be securely closed to prevent accidental opening.

5.1.2 Level B. Two racks of the same type and class shall be packaged in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type I, class 1, style optional. The racks shall be individually wrapped in Kraft paper or cushioned with suitable cushioning material to prevent abrasion and scratching. The box shall be secured in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.3 Level C. The racks shall be packaged in accordance with the suppliers commercial practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, B, or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Racks of the same type and class, packaged as specified in 5.1.1, shall be packed in close-fitting boxes conforming to PPP-B-621, class 2, style optional; or to PPP-B-601, overseas type, style optional; or to PPP-B-636, class 2, V3c, style RSC. The fiberboard boxes shall be closed, waterproof sealed with tape and reinforced with bands of filament tape in accordance with the appendix to the box specification. Each wood box shall be provided with a sealed case liner conforming to and sealed in accordance with MIL-L-10547. Closure and strapping shall be in accordance with the appendix to the applicable wood box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve racks (six packages of two each), of the same type and class, packaged as specified in 5.1.2, shall be packed in a close-fitting box conforming to PPP-B-636, type 1, class 1, style optional. Bursting strength of the fiberboard shall be not less than 275 p.s.i. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The racks shall be packed, to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination, in containers complying with the rules and regulations applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Fed. Std. No. 123.

5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

5.4 Standard Pack (Civil agency procurements). The Standard Pack for civil agency procurements shall be as specified in paragraphs 5.1.2 and 5.2.2 (see 6.4).

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. Distributor racks covered by this specification are intended to be placed on desks, tables, or filing cabinets for use in maintaining segregation of mail, documents, folders, catalogs and similar material.

6.2 Ordering data. Purchasers should exercise any desired options offered herein and procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number and date of this specification.
(b) Type, class and number of compartments (1.2.1).
(c) Whether stationary or adjustable partitions are required (3.3).
(d) Color (3.5).
(e) Levels of packaging and packing and any special marking required (5.1, 5.2, and 5.3).

6.3 It is believed that this specification adequately describes the characteristics necessary to secure the desired material and that normally no samples will be necessary prior to award to determine compliance with this specification. If, for any particular purpose, samples with bids are necessary, they should be specifically asked for in the invitation for bids, and the particular purpose to be served by the bid sample should be definitely stated, the specification to apply in all other respects.

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6.4 Standard Pack for civil agencies. The standard pack requirements in 5.4 are intended for use in procurements of Stores Stock replenishments. Procuring officers should use the standard pack requirements when it is known that the material will be shipped from a supplier to a domestic warehouse, supply depot or intermediate storage point for temporary storage, subsequent issue and/or shipment to eventual user.

6.5 Transportation data. Transportation description applicable to this item is:

Racks, not otherwise indexed by name.

Carload minimum weights:
Set-up, not flat, 10,000 pounds.
Knocked-down, not flat, 30,000 pounds.
Flat, knocked-down flat or folded flat, 30,000 pounds.

Truckload minimum weights:

Set-up, not flat, 10,000 pounds.
Knocked-down, not flat, 30,000 pounds.
Flat, knocked-down flat or folded flat, 30,000 pounds.

Notice. (See addendum attached hereto.)

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